



THE TROBRIAND ISLANDS ARE A SPRINKLING of coral islands

TROBRIANDERS

THE PACIFIC ISLANDS OF PARADISE

situated in Melanesia in the Pacific Ocean. Since 1975, the islands have been considered part of a larger area known as the Massim



THE KULA EXCHANGE

Kula is the inter-island, ceremonial trading network that involves the Trobriands and surrounding islands. It has been in action for over 500 years and is a means of trade. Each time a person arrives on an island to trade, they must offer either shell armbands or necklaces with elaborate ceremony. The *soulava*, shell necklaces, only ever travel in a clockwise direction around the islands and the armbands, *mwali*, only travel in a counterclockwise direction, and the same ones have been in circulation for hundreds of years.

FISHING

Outrigger canoes are used for fishing. The Trobrianders use nets, spears, and baited hooks to lure fish; they catch turtles using their hands. In deep water they dive down to incredible 30 ft (10 m) depths and cling on to coral with one hand while spearing with the other. Fish are caught as food for the village or for trade with other islands.

Ancient ways

When the Christian missionaries arrived in the early 20th century, they tried to quell many traditions on the islands, such as body decoration and the wearing of grass skirts. However, in time the islanders reverted to their old customs and, although most claim to be Christian, the religion doesn't impinge on traditional beliefs.

BANANA LEAF CURRENCY

There are many kinds of valuable items that are used as currencies in Papua New Guinea, including money made from shells. Trobrianders also have a kind of currency made from banana leaves.

